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Chapter 1

Drinks Sales Analysis Overview



Introduction

Drinks Sales Analysis enables you to produce your own views of sales information, to enable you to make comparisons and identify trends which are vital to strategic planning.

One of the great strengths of Drinks Sales Analysis is the extent to which each individual user is able to tailor the system to their own requirements without the need for any programming. This flexibility starts with the Sales History Database which is defined by the user, along with the level at which Sales History is held. The formats of enquiry are chosen by the user, and a new view of the information may be created quickly and easily without the need for data processing personnel.

Reports may be created via a simple series of prompts, may be requested on a regular basis or may be simple ad-hoc enquiries.

Relationship to Other Modules

Drinks Sales Analysis makes use of primary data held in Drinks Inventory Management and Drinks Sales Order Processing.

It is within Drinks Inventory Management that details of items are held, including data such as item type, item group, division and sub-division.

Drinks Inventory Management also contains a database of codes and descriptions, used to maintain an abbreviated code for such details as item group, or salesman, together with a meaningful description. The great benefit of the description database is that it enables a consistent and easily validated use of codes, and also provides for a meaningful description at report or enquiry time.

Customer details are held within Drinks Sales Order Processing, including data such as salesman, territory, and customer class.

Company Profile

As with all modules, Drinks Sales Analysis may be used by a number of companies, each with differing requirements. A profile of each company using the module is maintained, with details such as the name of the company and the level at which sales history is to be held.

Calendar

To maintain independence from financial or manufacturing time periods, Drinks Sales Analysis has its own calendar, which holds the dates on which sales weeks or periods end. This enables Drinks Sales Analysis to allocate each sale to the appropriate period, according to its date.

Budgets

Budgets may be defined within Drinks Sales Analysis, and have two main characteristics, a type and a format.

The type is an overall classification, such as 'Budget', 'Target' or 'Forecast'. The format describes the attribute or attributes to which the budget relates. For example, it is possible to have a 'Target' for Salesman, salesman being a possible item on the Sales History database, or a 'Forecast' for Customer account by Item group.

Budgets are entered by Sales History Period for a type and format previously defined. Spread profiles may be used to aid the creation of budgets, allowing an annual total to be spread over the year's sales periods according to a known pattern.

Drinks Sales Analysis reports enable the comparison of budgeted values with actual sales.

The Sales History Database

This is designed to enable a high level of tailoring to individual requirements without programming changes.

When the module is installed, you are able to choose the customer and item data elements which you wish to hold on the database. In addition to the item code, customer code and sales period, you may choose six data elements relating to the Drinks Inventory Management Item Master, and six relating to the Drinks Sales Order Processing Customer Master file. Quantity, Cost and Sales Value are also held, with provision for four further values.

You may also choose to change the screen and report headings for the data elements held on the database. For example, if you use Item type, to indicate whether an item is 'made in' or 'bought out', you can change the heading to say just that. This change is then fully incorporated within the database itself, allowing full utilisation of third party query utilities, which will print your chosen column headings.



Note: The database is common for all companies defined.

Updates and Processing

Sales History Update

Actual sales history is drawn from the Drinks Sales Order Processing invoice data. The Sales History Update function takes this data and adds it to the Sales History Database, using the calendar to determine the appropriate sales period.

This may be run as often as required, the actual frequency depending upon how up-to-date the Sales history needs to be.

Sales History Refresh

Drinks Sales Analysis enables you to selectively refresh customer or item data on the database in the event of a change.

For example, if sales regions are re-organised, so that customers fall into different regions, after the customer data in Drinks Sales Order Processing has been updated, it is possible to use the Sales History Refresh function to bring the Sales History Database into line with this re-organisation, and allow analysis to show past sales to customers, within their new regions.

Periodic Updates

Whilst Drinks Sales Analysis has no pre-defined 'month-end' reports, the functions are provided to allow you to run whatever regular reporting is required.

As you create your own reports, you are prompted to specify whether they are to be run on a regular basis, for example daily, or at month end. The daily, weekly, period-end, and year-end update functions select those reports you have requested, and produce them at the appropriate time.

These regular updates also maintain the current period and year, held on the company profile.

Enquiries

Drinks Sales Analysis provides a powerful enquiry function, which enables you to create a view of any data element on the database, analysed in terms of any other data item. The values displayed may also be chosen from the values on the database, and the time periods may be defined in a variety of different ways.

A new view may be created simply by asking for an analysis which has not previously been used, and the module will then offer to create it.

The Sales Enquiry provides you with four columns of values, chosen by means of a number of formats, created and set up at installation time.

A format specifies the time periods to be displayed, together with the particular value to be displayed.

For example:

- This period
- Last period
- 3 periods ago
- 4 periods ago
- Value to be shown = Sales Value.

Or:

- This period
- Last period
- This year
- Last year
- Value to be shown = Quantity.

To enquire on sales history, in a chosen format, you must enter two items:

- The data element on which to enquire.
- The data element by which to analyse.

For example, enquire on salesman '01' by item group, would show a breakdown by item group of salesman '01' sales. The enquiry may then be advanced to show the next salesman's sales by item group, and so forth.

Options are provided to invert the display, in order to show the sales of a selected item group by all salesmen, and thus view product group by salesman, in order to see the sales by all salesmen of a particular item group.

A bar chart function is also provided to give a graphical representation of the data.

Reports

Drinks Sales Analysis contains report generator functions which allow you to specify your own reports simply and quickly. For example, a report may be produced showing item sales summarised by salesman or a ranking of the best selling item groups comparing one sales period with another.

A report can be created to run regularly, perhaps at month-end, or a report may be used once to answer an ad-hoc enquiry.

Item File Print

This provides a listing of the items defined within Drinks Inventory Management, together with their attributes chosen for inclusion on the Sales History Database.

Customer File Print

This provides a listing of the Customers defined within Drinks Sales Order Processing, together with their attributes chosen for inclusion on the Sales History Database.

Report Specification Print

This function provides a listing of the specifications of reports defined within Drinks Sales Analysis.

Sales Report

The Drinks Sales Analysis system provides functions which enable you to run an existing sales report, or to create and optionally run a new or ad-hoc report.

Such is the ease of creating a report that Drinks Sales Analysis is particularly adept at providing reports for ad-hoc queries.

A report is created using a series of prompts by means of which you specify the report's sequence, selection and content, and when the report is to be run.

The report specification may be saved, and is then available to be run regularly, or on request.

Ranking Analysis

The Ranking Analysis function within Drinks Sales Analysis is used to sequence or rank elements by the results of a summarised value, and optionally, make comparisons between one period and another.

Thus, you could for example, choose to rank salesmen by sales value, which would summarise their sales values in order. You might choose to make a comparison and compare this month's ranking with last month's, to see what changes have taken place.

The ranking function may also be made to work at a second level, and rank one element within another. For example you could rank item groups within region, showing the best selling item groups for each region.

Utilities

Drinks Sales Analysis contains a set of utility functions which are intended for use at module installation time, or under certain special circumstances.

These utilities facilitate software installation, and continued maintenance.

Prerequisites

This section deals with all the steps involved from the initial installation of the module to the production of the first enquiries and reports.

Drinks Sales Analysis may be installed as an additional module within an existing environment, or may be part of a new installation.

The logical prerequisites are the same in both cases.

As with other products, Drinks Sales Analysis is supported by Application Manager, which must be installed first.

Drinks Sales Analysis also requires that Drinks Inventory Management and Drinks Sales Order Processing are installed. It obtains details from Drinks Inventory Management about the items which are sold and obtains details of customers and invoice details (representing sales) from Drinks Sales Order Processing .

In order for Drinks Sales Analysis to extract information about sales, the item details held within Drinks Inventory Management must be maintained so that the information for analysis is present. Likewise, the customer details required for analysis must be present within Drinks Sales Order Processing and some invoices must have been printed.

In order to print some of the reports contained in Drinks Sales Analysis, it is necessary to use printers which support 198 character line widths.

Module Configuration

Before you can use Drinks Sales Analysis you have to configure the module by providing the system with information on your business procedures.

These details can be split into five areas:

- Basic Data
- Database
- Budgets
- Sales History
- Technical Configuration

Entering Basic Data

You must enter the following basic data.

- Company Profile

A company profile must be created for each company which is to use the module. This contains processing details specific to each company, and also the current year and period, maintained by period-end routines.

- Calendars

Drinks Sales Analysis provides information grouped by sales period, whereas invoices are created as individual dates. In order for invoices to be placed in the appropriate period, a calendar is used.

Calendars must be created before processing starts. If you choose to hold history at a weekly level, calendars should be created for both week and period for all years which you intend to process.

- Sales History Time Period Selection

The information shown on the Drinks Sales Analysis enquiry is determined by the creation of formats.

These formats define the time periods and the values which will be shown, and must be created before any attempt is made to use the enquiry function of Drinks Sales Analysis.

A default format '1' is used by the module, and therefore, this at least must be created.

Database

Central to Drinks Sales Analysis is its database, which must be defined before processing is to start.

- Change Initial Field Descriptions

Within Drinks Sales Analysis, data elements or fields have internal names, which cannot be altered, but also external names by which they are identified to users of the system. The Change Initial Field Descriptions function may be used to step through the data elements, and change the names or descriptions of these in order to suit a particular installation.

- Define Database

The database must be created before processing can begin. You should consider the data elements which you wish to hold before you create the database. See the section 'Sales History Database'.

Budgets

Within Drinks Sales Analysis you may choose to maintain budgets, and in reports, compare budgets with actual sales. You may choose to run the module without budgets initially and introduce them later. A budget is defined in terms of a budget format and a budget type.

- Definition

In order to describe the data element(s) to which a budget applies, a format must be created. This also determines the kind of value to be held, for example, cost value or sales value.

The Budget Format function should be used to create the formats you require.

- Spread Profiles

The Spread Profiles function enables you to define the pattern of sales over a year, by period. A number of profiles may be created and used to aid budget entry.

- Budget Entry

Budgets may be entered for a year, against the data elements defined by the budget format, for the values also specified by the format.

Spread profiles may be used to spread an annual total over all periods in a year.

Sales History

Drinks Sales Analysis draws its information on sales from data within Drinks Sales Order Processing. For processing to start, invoices must have been printed within Drinks Sales Order Processing.

- Updating Drinks Sales Analysis

The Sales History Update function takes printed invoice data and posts the information to the Sales History Database. Once posted, the invoices are marked as such and will not be included in subsequent updates. If large volumes of data are involved this function may take some time to complete.

- Enquiry

The Sales Enquiry function will prompt you to enter a data element on which to enquire, and to select a data element by which to analyse. The first time a new enquiry combination is selected, the system will build summary data, but there after the enquiry will be performed straight away.

- Reporting

Drinks Sales Analysis enables you to create your own Sales Reports and Ranking Analysis Reports.

The Reports Specifications and Ranking Analysis Specification functions allow you to define reports quickly and easily. They may be created and run as part of the specification maintenance, or they may be selected by name at a later time, or included in the regular update runs.

Expert Menu Codes

You can access any menu in any linked module to which you are authorised by simply keying in the expert mode menu code of the menu you want from a command line.

This is done by entering a '/' followed by the code, e.g. /DAM (for the Drinks Sales Analysis Maintenance menu). The Drinks Sales Analysis codes are as follows:

<u>Code</u>	<u>Menu</u>
/DK	Customer Service and Logistics Initial Menu
/DA	Drinks Sales Analysis Initial menu
/DAP	Drinks Sales Analysis Processing menu
/DAM	Drinks Sales Analysis Maintenance menu
/DAE	Drinks Sales Analysis Reports and Enquiries menu
/DAU	Drinks Sales Analysis Utilities menu

The codes have been designed to be easily memorised. However, if you do forget a code, you can still enter the menu the normal way, and once there, the menu code is displayed in the top left hand corner.

You can go straight into a program by selecting the option number and menu at the same time. Simply enter the option number followed directly by a '/' and then the expert menu code. For example, instead of keying /DAM to get to the Maintenance menu and then taking option 4 to maintain calendars, simply keying 4/DAM takes you into the option. This is very convenient once the options you use most have become familiar to you.

Installing Application Manager PTF's

Application Manager PTF's must be restored and installed as QSECOFR.



Note: To install the Application Manager PTF's the system must be in a minimum state (that is with no users or subsystems / jobs running - this is important)

Use a normal User ID to create the state then sign off and sign on as QSECOFR.

At the first screen, add in library OSLPTP1 (ADDLIB OSLPTP1 *FIRST)

Type in MNGPTF and install the PTF as normal.

Once installed, the library and PTF object can only be removed by QSECOFR. Install this PTF then sign off and sign back in as PTFOWNER for subsequent PTF's.

If the above is NOT done, PTFOWNER, being inside Application manager, will say the AM PTF is installed when it has not, as PTFOWNER is using one of the objects the PTF requires, and the system will work - but will NOT have been updated.